



VR helps separate twins

Surgeons in separate countries wore headsets and operated in the same "VR room" together. <https://digit.in/sep22-09>



Decline in video game spending

Overall spending in the industry has decreased by 13% through Q2 2022 compared to Q2 2021. <https://digit.in/sep22-10>

billion UPI transactions recorded, amounting to over ₹10.62 trillion. These numbers showed a seven per cent increase over the numbers recorded a month earlier, in June.

However, the road to such levels of success isn't one without hurdles. As the number of adopters increased, the number of financial frauds also shot through the roof. Reports started flooding in about the increased rate of financial frauds occurring in the country, ranging from phishing-related scams to straight-up identity theft-related crimes.

There were privacy concerns, too, as UPI apps generally required location data before processing transactions. NPCI, taking note of these developments, issued incremental mandates for different platforms. The latest addition to the list is the one that requires all the UPI apps to require prior permission from the end users before recording their location data. This change is to be put into effect by all the platforms by December 1 latest. There have been multiple such mandates and consumer education initiatives put

into effect by service providers and government agencies.

While the road ahead looks promising, there are a lot of things yet to be seen. There are questions unanswered and hesitancy in the minds of the 'laggards' if we go by the terminology of the Diffusion of Innovation theory. These will need to be addressed before we move ahead and celebrate any other success or achievement of the platform. UPI has come a long way, but there's still a mountain to be scaled before it lands in its true and final form. **d**

Q With the fast-paced overseas adoption of UPI, what do you think the future has in store for UPI?

A There will be two aspects of it. One is individual countries or individual economies. Someone like the European Union will adopt it, and someone like Japan adopt it. It will, of course change a lot of things within their own internal networks. The countries will actually see a lot more digital adoption, even in countries where they are otherwise prevalent. I mean, Western economies are always accepting cards, but there are some very, very big benefits to UPI. One is you don't need the card machine. You don't need an internet connection. You don't need electricity connection. All you need as a merchant, is a QR code and a mobile phone, which could even be a feature phone. Right? All of a sudden you see that, the process becomes much, much smoother for the merchant himself. (When accepting cards, the merchant has to) take the card from the customer, swipe the card, the customer enters a pin, a receipt is generated for the merchant and customer. Most of these steps are avoided. So, individual economies will see an increase in digital option.

EXPERT'S TAKE

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The other thing that's going to happen is when a large number of countries are on the same network, you'll also start to have interoperability, which is very, very different. The only one current mode of payment for consumers that is interoperable are Visa, MasterCard cards. Those are the only modes of payment, which you can get in India and go to Europe and use it right now. And, unfortunately, you know, Visa and Mastercard are almost oligopolistic companies.

You know, just being in that setup, there is very less incentive to be customer friendly. There is not the right choice for the customers. Something like UPI is going to make it very, very transparent and seamless to connect the payment networks of multiple countries. It will truly bring 'customer convenience'. You'll get better features as a customer. You'll get more convenience as a customer. Imagine paying, using a PhonePe app for a baguette in France. It will be very liberating. You don't have this worry that, oh, did I take enough Forex? Uh, did I take a Forex card? Is my credit card charging me too high of an exchange fee? All of those concerns will go away. **d**